PATHFINDER

Opportunity Application Guide

A step-by-step guide to applying for bursaries, study places, work and competitions.

SINGAWE FOUNDATION NPC · YOUR JOURNEY. OUR COMMITMENT.

Before you start

- Gather your ID document (or your 13-digit ID number), latest results and proof of address.
- Make a folder - physical or digital - for every document a funder or institution might ask for.
- Note every closing date. Most opportunities do not accept late applications, no exceptions.

Applying for funding (bursaries and scholarships)

NSFAS and most bursary schemes open annually. Apply as early as the window opens - do not wait for an acceptance letter first. Keep a copy of every submitted application and its reference number.

Applying to study

University and TVET college applications usually open mid-year for the following year's intake. If you do not receive a place, the Central Applications Clearing House (CACH) opens in January as a second route into an institution with space available.

Applying for work

SAYouth.mobi is a zero-rated platform listing learnerships, internships and entry-level work across every province - it does not use your mobile data to browse.

Entering a competition

For science and innovation competitions such as the Eskom Expo for Young Scientists, start your project early and rehearse explaining it out loud - judges mark understanding, not memorised scripts.

Do not apply alone

COMHACK runs group application sprints and TACA sits beside you until submit is pressed. Both are free. If anything above is unclear, get help applying through the SINGAWE website and a form for exactly your kind of opportunity will reach us.